DETACHMENT — HORUS HERESY (30K)

SPITE OF THE GORGON

IRON HANDS (HH, LOYALIST) | WARHAMMER 40,000 | 11TH EDITION

Spite of the Gorgon is a fully homebrew Detachment for the Iron Hands (X Legion) faction — a Horus Heresy-era Loyalist Legion detachment adapted to the Warhammer 40,000 11th-edition Detachment framework, built from the real HH3e Iron Hands Rite of War data. Formatted to match the No Figure Left Behind Combat Patrol archive.

FACTION ABILITY

THE GORGON'S SCALES
Flesh gives way. What replaces it does not. Each time an attack targets a friendly Iron Hands unit, worsen the Strength characteristic of that attack by 1.

DETACHMENT RULE

SPITE OF THE GORGON
Detachment Points: To use this detachment you must spend 1 DP.

Every charge into an Iron Hands line is paid for before it lands. Once per battle, when an enemy unit declares a charge that targets a friendly Iron Hands unit, before Charge moves are made, you can select that Iron Hands unit: it can shoot the charging enemy unit, as though it were your Shooting phase. Until that attack is resolved, ranged weapons equipped by models in that unit have the [SUSTAINED HITS 1] ability.

FORCE DISPOSITIONS
This detachment has access to the following Force Disposition: Take and Hold.

DETACHMENT COMPOSITION

Included: All homebrew Iron Hands (HH) roster units (Ferrus Manus, Shadrak Meduson, Iron Father, Medusan Immortals Squad, Castellax Battle Maniple, Morlock Terminator Squad, Gorgon Terminator Squad, Castellax Destructor Maniple, Inductii Squad), and any homebrew Legiones Astartes (HH) unit from the generic Space Marines (HH) roster given the Iron Hands Trait.

Excluded: Any other Legion's Primarch or named characters. Non-Legiones-Astartes allies, per standard HH3e Legion-purity convention.

ENHANCEMENTS

FLESH METAL SOUL — *Character model only*
The bearer has a 5+ invulnerable save. If the bearer already has an invulnerable save, add 1 to its Invulnerable Save characteristic instead (to a maximum of a 3+ invulnerable save).

RELIC OF THE FORGE — *Character model only*
Each time the bearer fights, that model's melee weapons have the [DEVASTATING WOUNDS] ability.

STANDARD OF THE CLAN COMPANY — *Character model only*
While the bearer is leading a unit, each time a model in that unit is destroyed, roll one D6: on a 6, that model is not destroyed and instead is returned to the unit with 1 wound remaining.

UNFLINCHING LOGIC — *Character model only*
Each time the bearer's unit takes a Battle-shock test, that test is automatically passed.

STRATAGEMS

LEGION OF ONE **1CP**
Iron Hands — Battle Tactic Stratagem
When: Fight phase, just before a friendly Iron Hands Character unit fights, or Shooting phase, just before it shoots.
Target: That unit, if it is not within 6" of any other friendly unit.
Effect: Until the end of the phase, add 1 to Hit rolls for that unit's attacks.

REPLACE THE WEAK **1CP**
Iron Hands — Battle Tactic Stratagem

When: Any phase, just after a model in a friendly Iron Hands unit is destroyed.

Target: That unit.

Effect: Until the end of the turn, that unit's Toughness characteristic is increased by 1.

GRIM DETERMINATION **1CP**
Iron Hands — Strategic Ploy Stratagem

When: Your Command phase.

Target: One friendly Iron Hands unit.

Effect: Until your next Command phase, that unit is not Battle-shocked while it is below its Starting Strength.

MERCILESS RETALIATION **1CP**
Iron Hands — Epic Deed Stratagem

When: Fight phase, just after a friendly Iron Hands unit is destroyed.

Target: The enemy unit that destroyed it.

Effect: That enemy unit suffers 3 mortal wounds.

FORGE ANEW **2CP**
Iron Hands — Strategic Ploy Stratagem

When: Your Command phase.

Target: One friendly Iron Hands Vehicle unit.

Effect: Until your next Command phase, each time that unit is destroyed, before removing it from play, it can shoot or fight one more time.

COLD LOGIC **2CP**
Iron Hands — Battle Tactic Stratagem

When: Your Shooting phase, just after a friendly Iron Hands unit that Remained Stationary this turn is selected to shoot.

Target: That unit.

Effect: Until the end of the phase, ranged weapons equipped by models in that unit have the [LETHAL HITS] ability.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

Homebrew — HH3e (2026) Iron Hands Legion Rite of War → 11e conversion. Built from the real HH3e Rite of War data in `Iron Hands.json`, which has one baseline rite with three named pieces. Legion Tactica "The Gorgon's Scales" is real (-1 Strength on Shooting Attacks targeting a pure-Iron-Hands unit) → Faction Ability, translated directly. Gambit "Legion of One" (real: double the normal Outside Support Focus Roll bonus, cap the enemy's Outside Support bonus at +2) became the identically-named Stratagem, translated as a Hit-roll bonus conditional on fighting alone, preserving the real "needs no help, and denies the enemy's" spirit rather than the literal Focus-Roll mechanic. Advanced Reaction "Spite of the Gorgon" (real: once per battle, a pure-Iron-Hands unit targeted by a Charge can make a full-Ballistic-Skill overcharged Shooting Attack against the charger before the Charge resolves, denying the charger's own Volley Attack in return) was promoted to the Detachment Rule itself, matching how every other Legion's flagship real mechanic has anchored its own detachment — and a fitting flagship for a Legion that answers every act of violence with calculated, disproportionate retaliation. Replace the Weak, Grim Determination, Merciless Retaliation, Forge Anew, and Cold Logic are original stratagems filling out the standard six; Enhancements are original, themed around the Legion's cybernetic, unflinching, and forge-born identity.